

SHOWTIME

CLASSROOM GAMESHOWS

Teacher guide - version 1.2

Four revision games for the front of the classroom, inspired by classic TV quiz formats. They share one question bank and run from a single file, with no internet connection, logins or installs.



What's in Showtime

Over the Edge - 2 teams

A correct answer wins a counter to drop down a lane onto a moving shelf. Counters pushed over the front edge win £100. In the final, both teams join forces to push the gold jackpot counter over the edge for £5,000.

Outpace - 2 teams

Each team picks a deal and answers its way home before the Hunter catches it. Then both teams face a 60-second Final Sprint against a target set by their pot.

Category Clash - 2 to 4 teams

A board of categories and points values. Teams take turns to pick; harder questions are worth more, wrong answers can be stolen, and one hidden ★ tile is worth double. Ideal for whole-class revision across several topics.

Hex Hunt - 2 teams

A board of lettered hexagons. Each letter is the first letter of the answer. Win a hexagon to claim it and pick the next; the first team to link its two edges wins the round.

- **One shared question bank.** Pick a set once and every game uses it. Add your own sets by pasting plain text.
- **Starter packs.** 191 AQA-style questions for GCSE Combined Science (Biology, Chemistry and Physics packs plus an all-in-one mix), and a 61-question Homeostasis lesson set. These are written to match the AQA specification topics; they are not produced or endorsed by AQA.
- **Wrong-answer tracking.** Every wrong answer is saved against the team's name in every game, so weak topics follow them from game to game.
- **A friendly host.** Marty Marquee presents Over the Edge, greets you on the menu and adds short captions from the corner in the other games. You can rename and restyle him.
- **The same teams every where.** Team 1 is always blue ●, Team 2 orange ■, Team 3 purple ▲ and Team 4 teal ◆, and team names typed in one game fill in the others.

Getting started

1. Save **showtime-classroom-gameshows.html** somewhere on your computer, such as your Documents folder or a memory stick. Keep the same copy each lesson, because your question sets are saved for that browser.
2. Double-click it. It opens in your web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari). No internet connection is needed.
3. Put it on the board in full screen (press **F11** on Windows, or **Ctrl**+**Cmd**+**F** on a Mac).
4. On the menu, check the **Questions in use** line, then choose a game.

Tip: if a game feels slow on an older classroom PC, set **Graphics** to **Low** on the menu. It turns off shadows and glow effects without changing the game.

Setting up a game

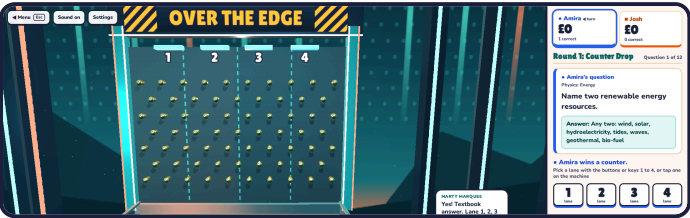
Each game opens on a setup card. Type the team names (they carry over to the other games), check the question set and press **Start** (or **Enter**).

- **Over the Edge** also lets you choose the number of Round 1 questions per team (4, 6 or 8), the number of final questions (8, 12 or 16) and how hard the jackpot is to win.

- **Category Clash:** choose 2 to 4 teams and 4 to 6 categories (topics from the question set; **Shuffle** picks a new mix), an optional answer timer, steals, a points penalty for wrong answers and the ★ tile.
- **Hex Hunt:** choose a 5 × 5 or 6 × 6 board and one round or best of three.
- Tick **Pick more questions from topics each team got wrong before** to steer questions towards each team's weak topics.
- Use ◀ **Menu** (or **Esc**) in the top corner to go back to the menu at any time. You will be asked first if a game is in progress.

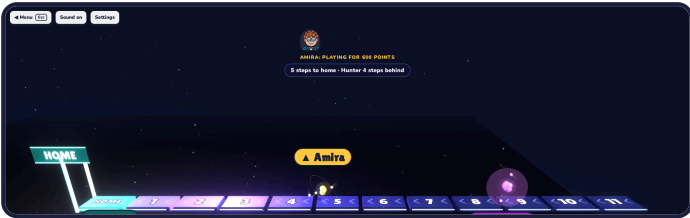
Running the games

Over the Edge



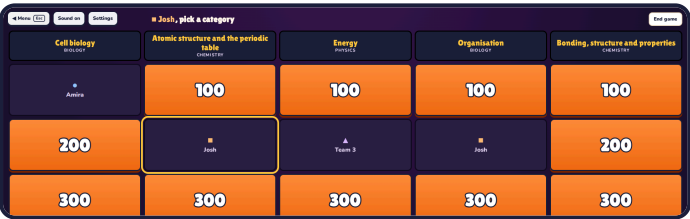
1. Read the question. Mark it **Correct** or **Wrong**; if wrong, the other side can steal it.
2. The winner picks a lane (1 to 4): buttons, keys, or tap the machine. Watch for ★ **wildcard counters**.
3. In the final the pair work as a team; each correct answer wins two counters.

Outpace



1. Pick a deal: **Cautious** (300, Hunter 5 steps back), **Standard** (600, 3 back) or **Bold** (1,000, 1 back).
2. Mark with **Correct** or **Wrong** as soon as the team answers; the answer appears as you mark. **Show answer** is there if you want it first. Reach home to bank the deal; if caught, bank half.
3. **Final Sprint:** 60 seconds, taking turns; each team can **pass** once.

Category Clash



1. The team named at the top picks a tile. Values run from 100 (easiest) to 500 (hardest).
2. Mark it **Correct** or **Wrong**. If wrong, press the number of the team that steals it, or **Nobody**.
3. Turns rotate. The game ends when the board is clear, or press **End game**.

Hex Hunt



1. The picking team chooses a hexagon. Read the question; the letter is the answer's first letter.
2. Press **1** or **2** for the team that answers first, then mark it. If wrong, the other team can answer.
3. The winner of a hexagon picks next. Link your two edges to win the round.

Keyboard shortcuts

Everything also works by mouse or touch. Keys are shown on the buttons. In every game **Enter** starts or replays from the setup and results screens, and **Esc** returns to the menu.

Over the Edge		
C / W	Correct / wrong (also for a steal)	
N	No attempt at the steal	
A	Show or hide the answer	
1 - 4	Drop the counter down that lane	
Space / Enter	Next question	

Outpace		
1 2 3	Cautious, Standard or Bold deal	
C / W	Correct / wrong (shows the answer too)	
A / Space	Show the answer first (optional)	
H	Pass to the other team (Final Sprint, once each)	
Enter	Continue after Escaped or Caught	

Category Clash		
← → ↑ ↓ Enter	Move around the board and open a tile	
C / W	Correct / wrong	
1 - 4 / N	That team steals it / nobody	
A	Show or hide the answer	
Enter	Back to the board	

Hex Hunt		
← → ↑ ↓ Enter	Move around the board and pick a hexagon	
1 / 2	That team answers first	
C / W	Correct / wrong	
N / A	Nobody knows / show the answer	
Enter	Back to the board, new question, next round	

Tips for running it with a class

- **Teams, not just two pupils.** Split the room into two halves and type team names. Let each team confer for ten seconds, then take one answer from a nominated pupil.
- **Everyone answers.** Ask the whole class to write each answer on mini whiteboards before you reveal it, so the game drives retrieval practice for everyone.
- **Use "Any two" answers generously.** Many answers list several acceptable points. You are the judge, so accept good alternatives.
- **Short on time?** In Over the Edge choose 4 Round 1 questions and 8 final questions (about 15 minutes). Outpace takes 10 to 15 minutes. A 4-category Category Clash board or a single round of Hex Hunt fits a 20-minute slot.
- **Whole class.** Category Clash suits 3 or 4 table teams; Hex Hunt works well as two halves of the room with hands up instead of buzzers.
- **Revisit weak topics.** The results screen lists each team's missed questions and their weakest topics across all games. Use it to plan a starter for next lesson.

Adding your own questions

Open **Question bank** on the menu (or **Manage the question bank** on a setup card). Type a name for the set, paste your questions in this format, and press **Save as new set**:

Subject: Chemistry

Topic: Bonding

Q: What type of bonding is in sodium chloride?

A: Ionic

Q: Why can metals conduct electricity?

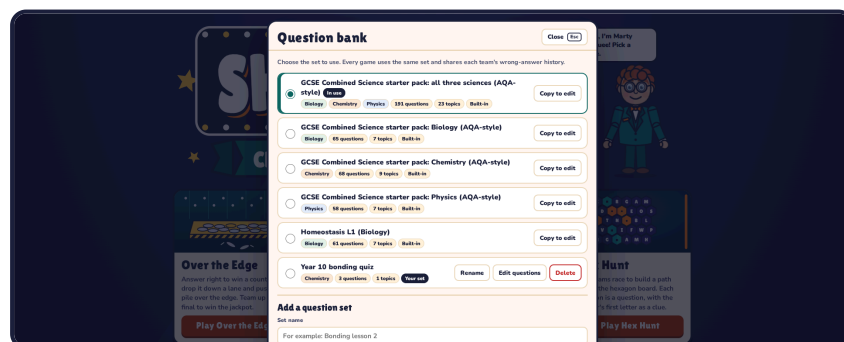
A: They have delocalised electrons that can move through the structure

Topic: Rates of reaction

Q: Give two ways to increase the rate of a reaction.

A: Any two: increase temperature, increase concentration, increase surface area, add a catalyst

- The **Subject** and **Topic** lines apply to every question below them until the next one. Topics drive the weak-topic tracking, so keep topic names consistent between sets.
- Every **Q:** line needs an **A:** line straight after it. Blank lines are ignored. Question sets from earlier versions of these games use the same format and paste straight in.
- Optional: a line such as **Difficulty: 4** (1 easy to 5 hard) applies to the questions below it. Category Clash puts level 1 on the 100 row up to level 5 on the 500 row, borrowing the nearest level if a row runs short. Every built-in question is already tagged. Other games ignore the line; without it, Category Clash estimates difficulty.
- A new set becomes the set in use for every game straight away. Use the round buttons to switch sets.
- **Rename, Edit questions** or **Delete** your own sets from the list. Deleting asks you to tap twice.
- The built-in packs cannot be changed, but **Copy to edit** makes your own copy that you can trim or add to.



Moving to another computer: backups

Press **Save backup file** to download one file containing all your own sets and every team's wrong-answer history. On the other computer, open Showtime, choose **Question bank** → **Load backup file** and pick that file. Loading a backup only adds; it never deletes anything already there, and loading the same file twice adds nothing new.

Teams' wrong answers

History is saved by team name, so use the same spelling each time (capital letters do not matter). The question bank lists every saved team; **Clear** removes one player's history. A player's history can also be cleared from the results screen.

Settings and accessibility

Setting	What it does
Sound	All sounds are short effects made by the browser. There is no music.
Text size	Large makes every panel, question and button bigger for the back of the room.
Reduced motion	Stops camera sway, screen shake and the flash when the Hunter catches someone, and shows the host's words at once. It starts switched on if your computer asks for reduced motion.
Graphics	Low turns off shadows and glow and draws at standard resolution, for older PCs.

Colours meet the WCAG AA contrast guidelines. Nothing relies on colour alone: teams are also marked ● ■ ▲ ◆ (Team 1 is always blue ●, Team 2 orange ■, Team 3 purple ▲, Team 4 teal ◆), wildcard counters carry a ★, the Hunter and the runner are labelled, and buttons show ✓ and ✗ as well as green and red.

Privacy and data protection

No data leaves the computer. Showtime makes no network connections at all: no analytics, no tracking, no accounts and no adverts. It even includes a browser security rule that blocks connections.

Question sets, team names, wrong-answer history, the host's look and your settings are saved only in the web browser on the computer you are using (in its local storage). They are not sent to us or anyone else.

For UK GDPR, this means the school stays in control: data stays on the school's device, you can delete a team's history at any time from the question bank, and a backup file is only created when you choose to save one. If you use pupils' names, treat backup files like any other file containing pupil data. You can also use first names, initials or team names instead.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
The file opens as text, or in a preview pane	Download or copy it to your computer first, then double-click it. Previews in email, Teams or OneDrive cannot run it.
"3D graphics are switched off"	Try another browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari). If it still appears, ask IT to turn on hardware acceleration in the browser settings.
The game is jerky or slow	Set Graphics to Low . Close other tabs and video calls.
No sound	Check Sound is on, the board's speakers are on, and the volume is up. Browsers only play sound after the first click or key press.
My question sets have gone	Sets are saved in one browser on one computer. Open the same file in the same browser you used before. Private or guest windows forget everything when closed, and some school setups clear browser data at log-off: keep a backup file and load it when needed.
"This browser is blocking storage" message	The games still work, but nothing is kept after you close the page. Use a normal (not private) window, or keep a backup file.
"No Q: and A: pairs found"	Check each question line starts with Q: and is followed by a line starting with A: .
Text is hard to read from the back	Turn on Large text size and use full screen (F11).
I pressed a key and nothing happened	Click once on the game area first, so the browser knows the keys are for the game. Keys are ignored while you type in a box.

About

Showtime: Classroom Gameshows, version 1.2.0. Game design and question packs by Rob Pearce. The games are original works inspired by classic TV quiz formats and are not connected with any television programme or broadcaster. AQA is a registered trade mark of AQA Education; the starter packs are AQA-style practice questions and are not endorsed by AQA.

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